

6. Description - Please attach a detailed narrative of the specific capital project that will be undertaken and funded pursuant to this application. Please check box to confirm narrative has been provided.

The Village of Saranac Lake is seeking NY SWIMS funding to complete the full construction and design of the Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park facilities, transforming the community's only public, lifeguarded swimming area into a modern, accessible, and environmentally sustainable waterfront destination.

This capital project will replace the aging, non-ADA-compliant bathhouse with a new, fully accessible facility that includes updated restrooms, and lifeguard/staff areas. Additional site improvements include ADA-accessible walkways and routes to the beach, upgraded fencing, native landscaping, improved drainage systems to address ongoing erosion, and safety enhancements for pedestrians and swimmers.

The project will ensure barrier-free access for residents and visitors of all ages and abilities, addressing long-standing community needs for equitable recreational opportunities. Lake Colby Beach is a key recreational and visual gateway into the Village, located directly along NYS Route 86 and widely used by families, youth, seniors, and visitors throughout Franklin and Essex Counties.

By modernizing this high-use waterfront park, the project supports the goals of the North Country Regional Economic Development Council (NCREDC) and the NY SWIMS initiative by increasing access to public swimming facilities, promoting outdoor recreation, improving water safety, and supporting public health and community vitality. Environmentally sensitive design will protect water quality in Lake Colby, minimize site disturbance, and incorporate native plantings to enhance stormwater management and the natural beauty of the site.

Once complete, the project will provide a vibrant, inclusive, and sustainable waterfront amenity that strengthens community pride, expands outdoor recreational access, supports local tourism, and enhances quality of life for residents and visitors to the Adirondack Park.